

****Artificial Intelligence and Privacy. Personal Data at Risk Online****

****Sharenting, a Danger for Children****

The Vice President of the Data Protection Authority, Cerrina Feroni, explains the bomb effect of new systems that collect information without consent.

****Profiling Individuals and Manipulating Thought****

Interview with Ginevra Cerrina Feroni, Vice President of the Data Protection Authority
(by Elettra Gullè, Quotidiano Nazionale, May 27, 2024)

Privacy and Artificial Intelligence, opportunities, risks, and challenges, a focus promoted by the Data Protection Authority today at Villa Bardini in Florence to develop a constructive dialogue with key public and private stakeholders on the future of data protection in a world characterized by technological innovation. Ginevra Cerrina Feroni, Vice President of the Authority, will open the proceedings after the greetings from President Pasquale Stanzone.

****What are the main privacy concerns related to the use of artificial intelligence and big data?****

"The impact of artificial intelligence on privacy and more generally on fundamental rights – responds the Vice President – is enormous. Regarding privacy, the main concerns are related to the vast collection of data, including personal data, from the web to train these systems without the consent of the individuals concerned. Furthermore, the latest developments in these technologies are leading to unprecedented profiling of individuals and new forms of thought manipulation."

****How do national security needs reconcile with the protection of citizens' privacy?****

"As a constitutionalist, I do not think that privacy is a tyrannical right that must prevail over all other values. There are public interests, such as national security, that deserve to be realized. However, it is essential to find a balance. Let us remember that the dividing line between security and mass surveillance is often very thin."

****What are the upcoming challenges you foresee for privacy in the coming years?****

"The G7 of Data Protection Authorities will focus on artificial intelligence. The goal is to develop a common response for the responsible circulation of personal data, for the development of artificial intelligence in respect of fundamental rights, and to promote closer cooperation among Data Protection Authorities globally. These are certainly the main challenges for the future."

One of the most current issues on the privacy front is the sharing on social media of images of one's children (sharenting).

"Sharenting has long been on our radar. There is much talk about digital education in schools, but adults must also understand the significant risks associated with the use of new technologies. Once exposed online, children are subject to serious dangers, such as the use of their image in child pornography or sexual grooming."

****Be cautious, then, about posting photos of birthdays and children's performances.****

"Certainly. By sharing even innocent photos that capture a happy moment, families disclose sensitive information about their children's habits. They may forever influence the development of their identity and their future social and work relationships. For these reasons, as the Authority, we advocate extending the protections currently provided for cyberbullying to also cover sharenting."

Today's meeting in Florence will also feature Luciano Violante (President of the Leonardo Foundation - Civilization of Machines Ets), Francesco Caio (President of Caio Digital Partners), and Luigi Rebuffi (Secretary General of Ecsso, European Cyber Security Organisation).